

EXPERIMENT NO. 2**Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform****1. AIM**

To create and configure a Zoho Creator account, develop a sample low-code application, design forms, reports, and dashboards, and understand the major platform modules such as Develop, Deploy, and Manage.

2. PROCEDURE**Step 1: Create a Zoho Creator Account**

- Open the Zoho Creator website using a web browser.
- Register with an email address or a Google account.
- Complete the email verification process and sign in.
- Open the Zoho Creator home page and access the application dashboard.

Step 2: Create a Sample Application

- Select Create New Application from the dashboard.
- Choose Blank Application to start a new project.
- Enter a suitable application name and description.
- Click Create to generate the application workspace.

Sample Application

A sample application named Corporate Asset is created to explore the basic features of Zoho Creator. The application is designed to store asset-related information and present the collected data through forms, reports, and dashboards. This provides practical experience in building an application using a low-code development environment.

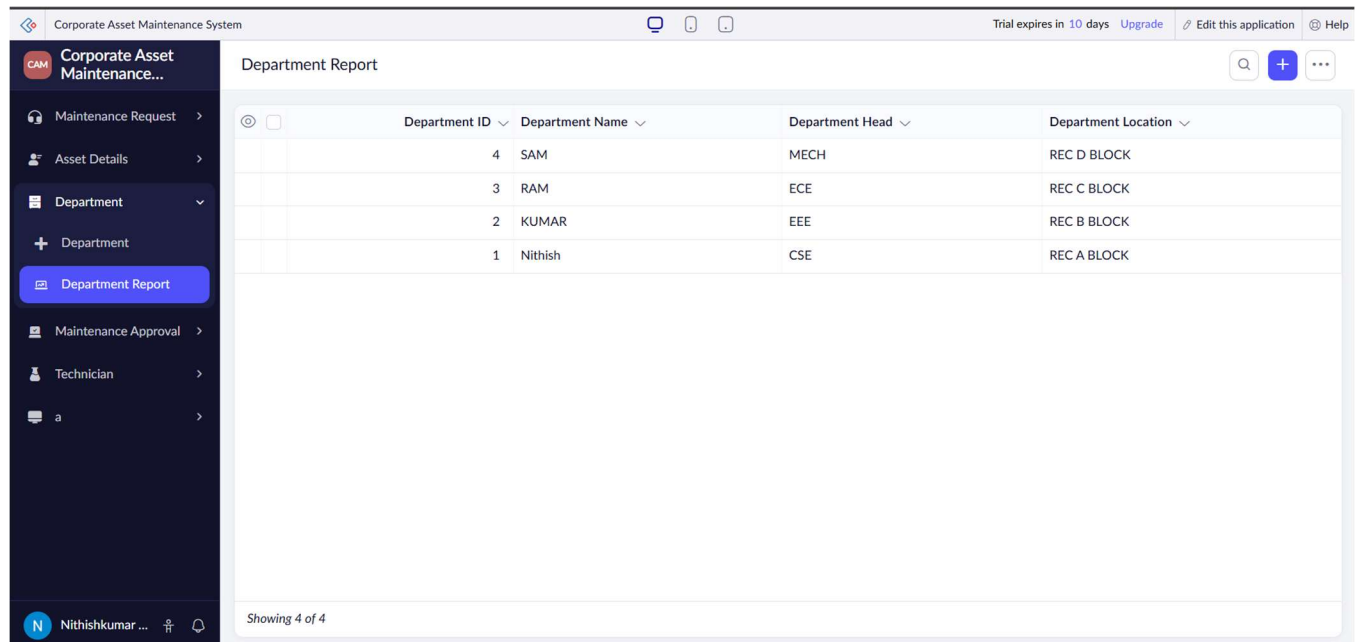
Creating a Form

The screenshot displays a web browser window with the URL `creatorapp.zoho.in/nithishkumar.s.2024.cse_r935/corporate-asset-maintenance-system#Form:department`. The application interface features a dark sidebar on the left with the title 'Corporate Asset Maintenance...' and a list of menu items: 'Maintenance Request', 'Asset Details', 'Department' (selected), '+ Department', 'Department Report', 'Maintenance Approval', 'Technician', and 'a'. The main content area is titled 'Department' and contains a form with the following fields: 'Department Name', 'Department Head', 'First Name', and 'Department Location'. At the bottom of the form are 'Submit' and 'Reset' buttons. The top right of the application shows a trial status: 'Trial expires in 10 days' with links for 'Upgrade' and 'Edit this application'.

A form is used to collect and store information from application users. It provides a structured interface for entering data. Different field types such as Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Email, Phone Number, Dropdown, Lookup, Checkbox, Radio Button, and File Upload can be added according to the application requirements.

To create a form, select Create → Form, enter the form name, and add the required fields using the drag-and-drop interface. Field properties such as data type, mandatory status, default value, and validation conditions can be configured. After saving, the form is ready to receive user entries.

Forms improve data organization by supporting validation, automatic calculations, and workflow automation. They help reduce incorrect entries and make data collection more efficient.



The screenshot displays the 'Corporate Asset Maintenance System' interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with navigation options: Maintenance Request, Asset Details, Department (selected), Department Report (highlighted in blue), Maintenance Approval, Technician, and a user profile 'a'. The main content area is titled 'Department Report' and contains a table with the following data:

Department ID	Department Name	Department Head	Department Location
4	SAM	MECH	REC D BLOCK
3	RAM	ECE	REC C BLOCK
2	KUMAR	EEE	REC B BLOCK
1	Nithish	CSE	REC A BLOCK

At the bottom of the table, it says 'Showing 4 of 4'. The top of the interface includes a header with 'Corporate Asset Maintenance System', a trial expiration notice 'Trial expires in 10 days', and links for 'Upgrade', 'Edit this application', and 'Help'.

A report displays and manages the records submitted through a form. It allows users to view stored information in an organized manner and perform operations on the records.

To create a report, select Create → Report, choose the required form, and select a suitable report format such as List, Summary, Calendar, Kanban, or Spreadsheet. The report can be customized by selecting fields, applying filters, sorting records, grouping information, and enabling search options.

Reports make it easier to search, review, edit, and analyze application data. They also help users obtain useful information from the collected records.

Creating a Dashboard

A dashboard provides a graphical and centralized view of important application information. It can contain charts, tables, reports, gauges, statistical widgets, buttons, and other visual components.

To create a dashboard, select Create → Dashboard, provide a suitable name, and add the required components. The components can be arranged, resized, and configured to create a clear layout.

Dashboards help users monitor key statistics, identify trends, and understand application data quickly. They provide an interactive overview without requiring users to open individual reports.

EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE**Develop**

- The Develop module is the primary workspace for designing and building applications.
- It provides visual tools for creating forms, reports, pages, dashboards, workflows, and schedules.
- Field properties and relationships between forms can be configured according to application needs.
- Deluge scripts can be used to implement advanced logic and automate business processes.
- External services can be integrated to extend application functionality.

Deploy

- The Deploy module is used to make the completed application available to intended users.
- Applications can be published for access through web browsers and supported mobile devices.
- User access, permissions, sharing options, and application updates can be configured.
- New versions can be published after changes are tested and approved.
- Deployment ensures that users receive the current version of the application.

Manage

- The Manage module is used for administration and maintenance after an application is deployed.
- Administrators can manage users, roles, permissions, and security settings.
- Application usage, storage, integrations, and user activities can be monitored.
- Backup and recovery-related options can be managed when required.
- The module supports the secure and reliable maintenance of the application throughout its lifecycle.

RESULT

Thus, a Zoho Creator account was successfully configured and a sample Corporate Asset application was developed. Forms, reports, and a dashboard were created to understand the main features of the platform. The Develop, Deploy, and Manage modules were also explored. The experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator supports rapid application development through a low-code approach with reduced programming effort.